



Semaphore error

Here is a tip that will help you solve the semaphore error we get while trying to restart Apache/httpd, as shown below:

```
critical_create(): semget() failed: No space left on device
```

To see how many semaphores are being used, use the following command:

```
ipcs -s
```

In order to get Apache started again, we must clear the semaphores. Run this for-loop to flush them, and now you can start Apache service, as follows:

```
for i in `ipcs -s | grep apache | awk '{ print $2; }'; do  
ipcrm -s $i; done
```

– *Remin Raphael,*
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Delete only the contents of a file

Often, we need to delete only the contents of a file and not the file itself. For this purpose, the 'truncate' command can be used.

```
# truncate -s 0 <file name>
```

The above command deletes all the contents of the specified file and doesn't delete the file.

```
# truncate -s 0 contacts.txt
```

The above command deletes all the contents of the file named 'contacts.txt'.

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Find out the total number of directories and files present in your system

To find out the total number of directories or files, use the Tree command. Tree can list the contents of the directories in a tree-like format. You may have to install tree in your system first, if it has not already been done.

On an Ubuntu or Debian based system, run the following command:

```
#apt-get install tree
```

For RPM based systems, run the following:

```
#yum install tree
```

After installing it, run the following command:

```
#tree / | tail -1
```

This will show the total number of directories and files on the system. If you want to get the same information for the directory, run the command given below:

```
#tree name-of-the-directory/ | tail -1
```

For example:

```
$ tree .mozilla/ | tail -1  
53 directories, 138 files
```

– *Kousik Maiti,*
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How to force users to change their passwords when next logging in to Linux

If you want to force a user to change her password on her next login, in Linux, you need to log in using root user rights and execute the command shown below: